ENGLISH C2 · ADVANCED GRAMMAR

Concessive conditionals

Use even if, whether, no matter and wh-ever forms to combine hypothetical range with a result that remains unchanged. The lesson connects form, meaning, register and real editorial decisions rather than treating the pattern as an isolated rule.

THE CENTRAL IDEA

Use concessive conditionals to assert that a conclusion survives every relevant condition or degree while preserving the intended meaning and register.

Use even if, whether, no matter and wh-ever forms to combine hypothetical range with a result that remains unchanged.

MODEL

Whatever the final cost may be, the safety work must continue.

concessive conditional range + invariant result

6 GUIDED STAGES · 30 LEARNING DECISIONS

This complete guide combines explanation, visual reasoning, practice and feedback. Separate exercise and answer-key editions are also available from the lesson page.

LEARNING OUTCOMES

OUTCOME 1

01

Recognise the main concessive conditionals patterns in authentic contexts.

OUTCOME 2

02

Choose a form that accurately expresses assert that a conclusion survives every relevant condition or degree.

OUTCOME 3

03

Avoid errors that change time, agency, emphasis or speaker commitment.

OUTCOME 4

04

Use the structure appropriately in argument, policy, negotiation and emphatic generalisation.

Build meaning before form

Use even if, whether, no matter and wh-ever forms to combine hypothetical range with a result that remains unchanged.

What concessive conditionals communicates

Use even if, whether, no matter and wh-ever forms to combine hypothetical range with a result that remains unchanged.

The central purpose is to assert that a conclusion survives every relevant condition or degree. A successful choice therefore preserves the proposition while making the intended relationship, viewpoint or degree of commitment visible to the reader.

The review will continue even if the complaint is withdrawn.	a result maintained under a possible contrary condition
Whatever the final cost may be, the safety work must continue.	an invariant result across an unrestricted range
Whether approved now or next month, the reform will face opposition.	the same result across two alternatives

How the pattern is built

Use this working formula: concessive conditional range + invariant result. The formula is a decision path: it identifies the trigger, the clause architecture and the element that carries tense or modality.

The model “Whatever the final cost may be, the safety work must continue.” shows the complete pattern in context. Rebuild the sentence from meaning to form instead of translating each word independently.

Choice	Structure	Example
Unchanged hypothetical result	even if + clause, result	The review will continue even if the complaint is withdrawn.
Free-choice concession	whatever/whoever/however + clause	Whatever the final cost may be, the safety work must continue.
Alternative concession	whether X or Y, result	Whether approved now or next month, the reform will face opposition.

Choose by meaning, not by surface similarity

Neighbouring structures may contain similar words but perform different jobs. Compare the three reference patterns and name the intended effect before completing the sentence.

A reliable answer explains both why the chosen form works and why a plausible alternative would change the meaning, time relation, information focus or level of certainty.

Meaning	Best route
a result maintained under a possible contrary condition	Unchanged hypothetical result
an invariant result across an unrestricted range	Free-choice concession
the same result across two alternatives	Alternative concession

Register, discourse and editorial control

This grammar is especially useful in argument, policy, negotiation and emphatic generalisation. Its value comes from helping the reader process a relationship efficiently, not from making the sentence sound artificially complex.

After editing, check recoverability, natural word order and consistency with the surrounding paragraph. If the marked structure creates ambiguity, return to a fuller or more neutral clause.

Reason through the pattern

The visual map moves from communicative purpose to structural trigger, then to the final clause. It keeps meaning and form visible at the same time so the learner can justify every choice.

01	02
concessive conditional range	invariant result

DECIDE IN THIS ORDER

STEP 1

Decision 1

Identify the communicative purpose before selecting a form: assert that a conclusion survives every relevant condition or degree.

STEP 2

Decision 2

Locate the structural trigger and match it to one of the reference patterns.

STEP 3

Decision 3

Check time reference, clause relationships, agency and speaker commitment.

STEP 4

Decision 4

Read the complete sentence in context and confirm that its register suits argument, policy, negotiation and emphatic generalisation.

STEP 5

Decision 5

Compare the result with a neutral alternative and keep the marked form only when it adds useful meaning.

Compare forms and meanings

Use the table to justify each structural choice.

Pattern	Form	Model
Unchanged hypothetical result	even if + clause, result	The review will continue even if the complaint is withdrawn.
Free-choice concession	whatever/whoever/however + clause	Whatever the final cost may be, the safety work must continue.
Alternative concession	whether X or Y, result	Whether approved now or next month, the reform will face opposition.

EXAMPLES AT A GLANCE

The review will continue even if the complaint is withdrawn.	a result maintained under a possible contrary condition
Whatever the final cost may be, the safety work must continue.	an invariant result across an unrestricted range
Whether approved now or next month, the reform will face opposition.	the same result across two alternatives

COMMON ERRORS

EDIT THIS

Avoid this pattern

Do not use even though when the condition is not known to be factual.

EDIT THIS

Avoid this pattern

Do not add a separate antecedent before a fused free-choice relative.

EDIT THIS

Avoid this pattern

Keep the two alternatives structurally parallel.

Recognition in context

Choose the sentence whose grammar matches the stated communicative purpose.

A1 · MEANING DECISION 1

Which sentence best communicates this purpose: a result maintained under a possible contrary condition?

OPTIONS The review will continue even if the complaint is withdrawn. · Whatever the final cost may be, the safety work must continue. · Whether approved now or next month, the reform will face opposition.

A2 · MEANING DECISION 2

Which sentence best communicates this purpose: an invariant result across an unrestricted range?

OPTIONS Whatever the final cost may be, the safety work must continue. · Whether approved now or next month, the reform will face opposition. · The review will continue even if the complaint is withdrawn.

A3 · MEANING DECISION 3

Which sentence best communicates this purpose: the same result across two alternatives?

OPTIONS Whether approved now or next month, the reform will face opposition. · The review will continue even if the complaint is withdrawn. · Whatever the final cost may be, the safety work must continue.

A4 · INTERPRETATION 4

What does “The review will continue even if the complaint is withdrawn.” communicate in this context?

OPTIONS a result maintained under a possible contrary condition · an invariant result across an unrestricted range · the same result across two alternatives

A5 · INTERPRETATION 5

What does “Whatever the final cost may be, the safety work must continue.” communicate in this context?

OPTIONS an invariant result across an unrestricted range · the same result across two alternatives · a result maintained under a possible contrary condition

A6 · INTERPRETATION 6

What does “Whether approved now or next month, the reform will face opposition.” communicate in this context?

OPTIONS the same result across two alternatives · a result maintained under a possible contrary condition · an invariant result across an unrestricted range

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

02 · PRACTICE STAGE

Form and function

Identify both the structural family and the meaning carried by each model.

B1 · FORM AND FUNCTION 1

“The review will continue even if the complaint is withdrawn.” uses _____ to express _____.

OPTIONS Gap 1: Unchanged hypothetical result / Free-choice concession / Alternative concession · Gap 2: a result maintained under a possible contrary condition / an invariant result across an unrestricted range / the same result across two alternatives

B2 · FORM AND FUNCTION 2

“Whatever the final cost may be, the safety work must continue.” uses _____ to express _____.

OPTIONS Gap 1: Free-choice concession / Alternative concession / Unchanged hypothetical result · Gap 2: an invariant result across an unrestricted range / the same result across two alternatives / a result maintained under a possible contrary condition

B3 · FORM AND FUNCTION 3

“Whether approved now or next month, the reform will face opposition.” uses _____ to express _____.

OPTIONS Gap 1: Alternative concession / Unchanged hypothetical result / Free-choice concession · Gap 2: the same result across two alternatives / a result maintained under a possible contrary condition / an invariant result across an unrestricted range

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

Guided discourse choices

Maintain accurate form and meaning across a connected sequence of decisions.

C1 · EDITORIAL PLANNING

Choose the model that expresses a result maintained under a possible contrary condition: _____. Choose the model that expresses an invariant result across an unrestricted range: _____. Choose the model that expresses the same result across two alternatives: _____. Choose the model built with even if + clause, result: _____. Choose the model built with whatever/whoever/however + clause: _____. Choose the model built with whether X or Y, result: _____.

_____
_____

WORD BANK

Available forms

The review will continue even if the complaint is withdrawn. · Whatever the final cost may be, the safety work must continue. · Whether approved now or next month, the reform will face opposition.

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

04 · PRACTICE STAGE

Open reconstruction

Recover the missing structural trigger without a word bank.

D1 · INDEPENDENT RECONSTRUCTION

The review will continue _____. _____, the safety work must continue. _____, the reform will face opposition. State the full structural pattern for Unchanged hypothetical result: _____. State the full structural pattern for Free-choice concession: _____.

_____
_____
_____
_____

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

Controlled transformation

Rewrite the neutral source so that it performs the requested advanced function.

E1 · TRANSFORMATION 1

Rewrite “Withdrawal would not stop the review.” using the Unchanged hypothetical result pattern to express a result maintained under a possible contrary condition.

_____
_____

E2 · TRANSFORMATION 2

Rewrite “Every possible cost leads to the same requirement.” using the Free-choice concession pattern to express an invariant result across an unrestricted range.

_____
_____

E3 · TRANSFORMATION 3

Rewrite “Timing will not remove opposition.” using the Alternative concession pattern to express the same result across two alternatives.

_____
_____

E4 · TRANSFORMATION 4

Rewrite “Withdrawal would not stop the review.” using the Unchanged hypothetical result pattern to express a result maintained under a possible contrary condition.

_____
_____

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

Communicative production

Use the grammar independently in realistic academic, professional and conversational contexts.

F1 · PRODUCTION TASK 1

Write two connected sentences about a realistic situation. Use Unchanged hypothetical result to express a result maintained under a possible contrary condition, then add a neutral sentence that makes the contrast clear.

_____
_____
_____

F2 · PRODUCTION TASK 2

Write two connected sentences about a realistic situation. Use Free-choice concession to express an invariant result across an unrestricted range, then add a neutral sentence that makes the contrast clear.

_____
_____
_____

F3 · PRODUCTION TASK 3

Write two connected sentences about a realistic situation. Use Alternative concession to express the same result across two alternatives, then add a neutral sentence that makes the contrast clear.

_____
_____
_____

Final self-check

Complete these prompts without reopening the guide.

R1 · REVIEW FOCUS

Explain and exemplify: communicative purpose.

_____
_____
_____

R2 · REVIEW FOCUS

Explain and exemplify: structural trigger.

_____
_____
_____

R3 · REVIEW FOCUS

Explain and exemplify: meaning contrast.

_____
_____
_____

R4 · REVIEW FOCUS

Explain and exemplify: register choice.

_____
_____
_____

Recognition in context

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

A1

The review will continue even if the complaint is withdrawn.

Unchanged hypothetical result is the best match because a result maintained under a possible contrary condition.

A2

Whatever the final cost may be, the safety work must continue.

Free-choice concession is the best match because an invariant result across an unrestricted range.

A3

Whether approved now or next month, the reform will face opposition.

Alternative concession is the best match because the same result across two alternatives.

A4

a result maintained under a possible contrary condition

The Unchanged hypothetical result pattern communicates a result maintained under a possible contrary condition.

A5

an invariant result across an unrestricted range

The Free-choice concession pattern communicates an invariant result across an unrestricted range.

A6

the same result across two alternatives

The Alternative concession pattern communicates the same result across two alternatives.

Form and function

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

B1

Unchanged hypothetical result / a result maintained under a possible contrary condition

The structure belongs to the Unchanged hypothetical result pattern. Its communicative purpose is a result maintained under a possible contrary condition.

B2

Free-choice concession / an invariant result across an unrestricted range

The structure belongs to the Free-choice concession pattern. Its communicative purpose is an invariant result across an unrestricted range.

B3

Alternative concession / the same result across two alternatives

The structure belongs to the Alternative concession pattern. Its communicative purpose is the same result across two alternatives.

Guided discourse choices

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

C1

The review will continue even if the complaint is withdrawn.

Unchanged hypothetical result: even if + clause, result.

C2

Whatever the final cost may be, the safety work must continue.

Free-choice concession: whatever/whoever/however + clause.

C3

Whether approved now or next month, the reform will face opposition.

Alternative concession: whether X or Y, result.

C4

The review will continue even if the complaint is withdrawn.

Unchanged hypothetical result: even if + clause, result.

C5

Whatever the final cost may be, the safety work must continue.

Free-choice concession: whatever/whoever/however + clause.

C6

Whether approved now or next month, the reform will face opposition.

Alternative concession: whether X or Y, result.

Open reconstruction

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

D1

even if the complaint is withdrawn

Unchanged hypothetical result requires “even if the complaint is withdrawn” in this model. even if + clause, result.

D2

Whatever the final cost may be

Free-choice concession requires “Whatever the final cost may be” in this model. whatever/whoever/however + clause.

D3

Whether approved now or next month

Alternative concession requires “Whether approved now or next month” in this model. whether X or Y, result.

D4

even if + clause, result

Unchanged hypothetical result is built as even if + clause, result.

D5

whatever/whoever/however + clause

Free-choice concession is built as whatever/whoever/however + clause.

Controlled transformation

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

E1

The review will continue even if the complaint is withdrawn.

even if + clause, result. The rewrite preserves the core message while adding the intended unchanged hypothetical result effect.

E2

Whatever the final cost may be, the safety work must continue.

whatever/whoever/however + clause. The rewrite preserves the core message while adding the intended free-choice concession effect.

E3

Whether approved now or next month, the reform will face opposition.

whether X or Y, result. The rewrite preserves the core message while adding the intended alternative concession effect.

E4

The review will continue even if the complaint is withdrawn.

even if + clause, result. The rewrite preserves the core message while adding the intended unchanged hypothetical result effect.

Communicative production

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

F1

The review will continue even if the complaint is withdrawn. The surrounding context would then state the same situation in neutral order or with a less marked commitment.

A strong response uses even if + clause, result accurately and makes the communicative purpose visible in context.

F2

Whatever the final cost may be, the safety work must continue. The surrounding context would then state the same situation in neutral order or with a less marked commitment.

A strong response uses whatever/whoever/however + clause accurately and makes the communicative purpose visible in context.

F3

Whether approved now or next month, the reform will face opposition. The surrounding context would then state the same situation in neutral order or with a less marked commitment.

A strong response uses whether X or Y, result accurately and makes the communicative purpose visible in context.

Diagnose the pattern, not only the score

Use this page to decide what to revisit in the complete guide.

CHECK · TRIGGER OR CONTEXT

What went wrong? What rule will prevent the same error next time?

_____
_____
_____

CHECK · AUXILIARY OR STRUCTURAL CHOICE

What went wrong? What rule will prevent the same error next time?

_____
_____
_____

CHECK · MAIN VERB OR CLAUSE FORM

What went wrong? What rule will prevent the same error next time?

_____
_____
_____

CHECK · MEANING AND REGISTER

What went wrong? What rule will prevent the same error next time?

_____
_____
_____